

University Major Analysis

Source: kaggle.com/datasets/sergionefedov/college-major-roi

STEM degrees such as engineering result in the highest salaries and are the faster option to paying back tuition.

Net ROI per major is broken down into two categories: High Achiever, which is a student completing their degree on time and working an internship, and Minimalist, which does neither. The biggest disparity here is towards the bottom of the return on investment. For example, Criminal Justice graduates who did not complete their degree on time or work an internship earned an average of close to 0, while doing both provided an average return of over \$62,000.

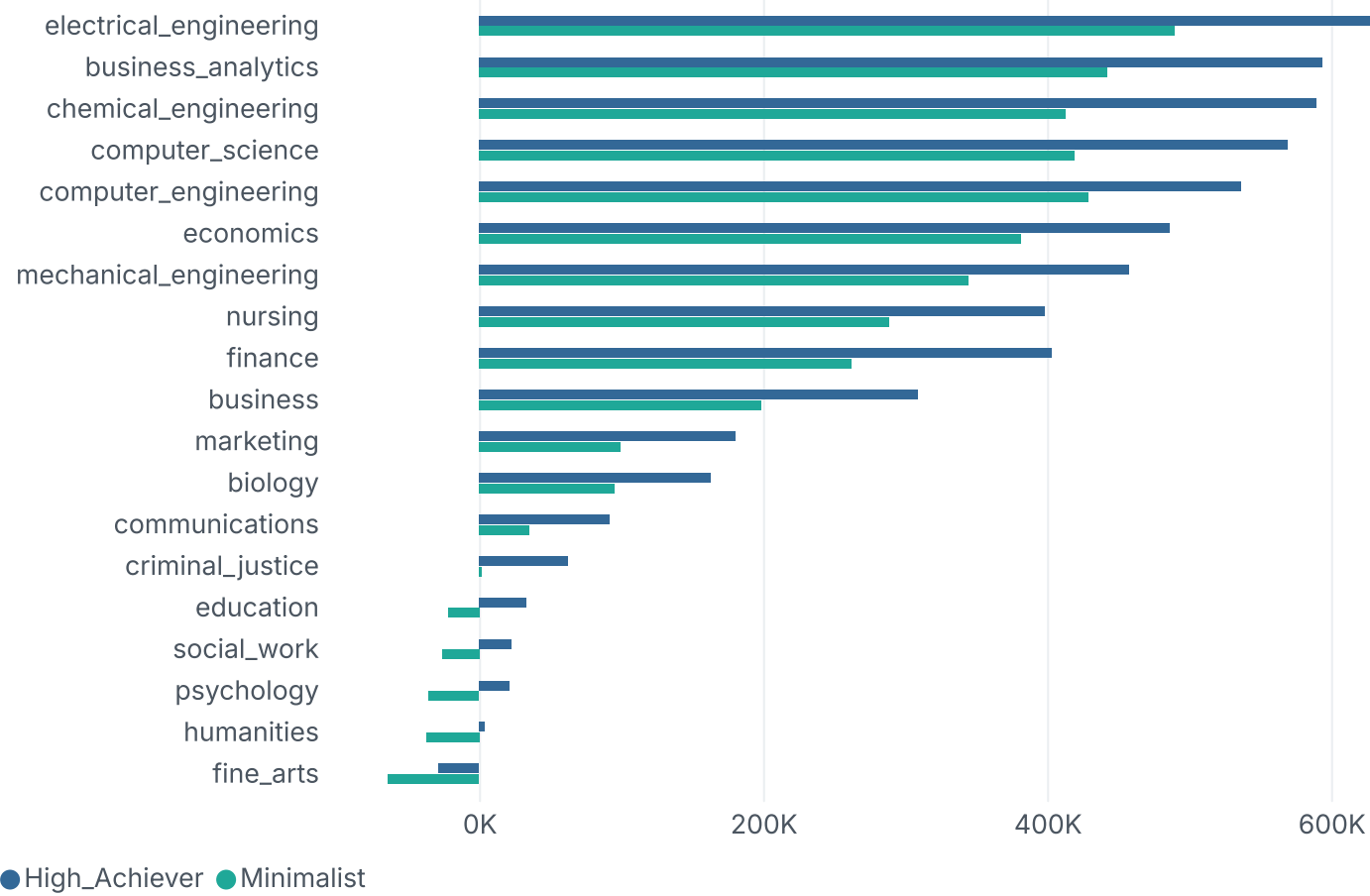
On average, fine arts is a major that has negative ROI no matter how much extra work the student does. The data shows -\$28,000 at best. What makes it an especially rough choice financially, is that the average cost of a fine arts degree is just a few thousand less than that of an engineering degree.

The most comfortable major in regards to salary and becoming debt free the fastest, is electrical engineering. Not into engineering? Finance, nursing, and marketing are close behind, landing graduates good salaries and paying off debt in about 2 years.

Another sweet spot is a business degree, which is low cost and can be paid back relatively quickly, plus it sits in the middle of the pack in ROI, and the reward for being a high achiever gets you in the ballpark of a minimalist engineer.

Internships and on-time completion swing several majors to higher ROI

Net ROI per Major Broken down by Achievements



Major	Average Salary
electrical_engineering	105063
chemical_engineering	97379
business_analytics	97377
computer_science	96675
computer_engineering	94172
economics	89359
mechanical_engineering	87533
nursing	80186
finance	79838
business	71688
marketing	59440
biology	58346
communications	51726
criminal_justice	48819
education	45944
social_work	45528
psychology	44983
humanities	43579
fine_arts	40885

Salary, not sticker price, drives how fast a degree pays for itself

Average Salary and Years to Earn Back Tuition by Majors

